

World Bank support to the
SUPPORTING ANDHRA'S LEARNING TRANSFORMATION (SALT) Operation
(Loan No. 9259-IN)

Sixth Implementation Support Mission (ISM)

September 23- 25, 2025

Mission Notes

I. INTRODUCTION

The sixth ISM for SALT was held from September 23–25, 2025. The operation has maintained steady momentum since exiting problem status following the mid-term review in November 2024, with consistent progress across the three core results areas. In June 2025, the Government of Andhra Pradesh cancelled US\$37.12 million from the Program-for-Results (PforR) component, and the Program was subsequently restructured to reflect this change. The agreed Results Framework and Disbursement Linked Indicators (DLIs) remain unchanged, and DLI achievements will continue to be verified by the Independent Verification Agency (IVA). Overall, the Department of School Education (DoSE) is progressing satisfactorily and is expected to achieve all remaining targets by the Program closing date of December 31, 2026. The tables below summarize key data and ratings from the 6th ISM.

Key Program Data as on September 27, 2025

Program Data	US\$ (millions)
Original Program Amount	250
Amount Cancelled	37.12
New Program Amount	212.88
Total Disbursement	193.67 (90.98%)
Disbursement in FY26 (since July 1, 2025)	5.5
Current Closing Date	December 31, 2026

Program Ratings as per the Sixth ISM

Program Ratings	
Progress towards achievement of Program Development Objective	Satisfactory
Overall Implementation Progress	Moderately Satisfactory

II. STATUS OF PROGRAM ACTIVITIES

RA 1- Strengthening Foundational Learning

Schools and CwSN Infrastructure (DLI 4). As of July 2025, DoSE delivered standardized packages to 567 CwSN resource centers, exceeding the DLI 4, DLR 4 target. However, about 3,000 schools under Phase 2 are yet to finalize their compound walls (DL4, DLR 2 target). DoSE is actively working on using MGNREGA resources to complete these works by June 2026. The mission clarified that although the partial loan cancellation removed the remaining funds under DLI 4, DoSE is still expected to complete the pending DLR by June 2026 and submit it for verification.

Foundational Literacy and Numeracy. Teacher training has been on hold since June 2025 due to union tensions but will resume in mid-October 2025 with 16,000 new teachers. To date, 90% of early grade teachers have completed 20 of the 60 required training days (**DLI 5**). For Anganwadi workers, 6 of the 120 training days are complete, and smartphones are being distributed to enable 34 days of online training from October 2025. DoSE must accelerate implementation to ensure the full 60-day, and 120-day training courses are completed before Program closing. The provision of TLM is progressing: *Jaadui Pitaara* kits are being distributed to 12,000 schools, while another 26,000 schools are receiving print-rich FLN kits and instructional materials. Under BaLA, 4,370 schools receive posters, and 1,507 schools are procuring child-friendly furniture. Performance in the 41 MFS has improved in both English and Telugu, with stronger gains in English. For monitoring and mentoring, the TEACH tool will also be applied in Anganwadi, with WCD approving the pairing of Child Development Project Officers and Pratham Resource Persons to support these activities. DoSE's support was requested in developing communication materials to strengthen community engagement and in conducting a SWOT analysis of co-located schools to inform future Central Government policy.

RA 2- Improved Quality of Teaching-Learning Interactions

Need-based In-service Teacher Training (DLI6). To date, 34% of teachers (against a 50% end target) have received need-based training. With training set to resume in mid-October, the Science course is ready for rollout on DIKSHA, while the Social Science and Inclusive Education courses are under review. DoSE must accelerate rollout of these three courses to meet milestones by June 2026. The State also aims to build SCERT's capacity to independently conduct Teacher Needs Analysis surveys and co-develop at least one course, with LFE providing technical support as needed.

School Based Coaching/Mentoring (DLI 2). Targets for improving teaching practices have been achieved. The final round of classroom observations using the TEACH tool, delayed by union tensions, will begin in mid-October. The mission stressed the need to increase observation frequency beyond teacher mapping. To institutionalize this, DoSE will (i) train school inspectors, MEOs, AMOs, and DIET faculty to integrate observations into their roles, and (ii) develop KPIs for SCERT and DIETs linked to teacher professional development. A training course in July covered 52 participants from SCERT, SAC, and Samagra Shiksha, with further sessions planned for DIET faculty. In parallel, teacher handbooks for all subjects from Grades 3–10 have been created and distributed statewide—marking a first in India.

Student Learning Assessment. The State Assessment Cell (SAC) has recruited new subject experts to replace those who were transferred out. However, capacity building is still underway, with only one of the seven planned training sessions completed. SCERT continuous leadership and prioritization will be essential to complete training and prepare for the 2026 State-Level Achievement Survey (**DLI 1**). CBA 10 was conducted with printed booklets, but data remains school-level; faster rollout of scanning technology is needed to centralize data, enable timely analysis, and produce misconception posters for targeted remediation (**DLI 7**). DoSE must also ensure insights from data inform classroom instruction and training. Given the scope of work, SAC should be further strengthened with additional subject experts, a data analyst, and a psychometrician.

Personalized Adaptive Learning (PAL) solution. PAL is being rolled out in 700 residential schools serving girls and tribal students, with content in the process of being adjusted to align with the National Curriculum Framework for language subjects. DoSE must provide data on the number of PAL sessions recorded taken by students to update the Results Framework and demonstrate effective rollout. Evidence from a study by economist Michael Kremer in 700 non-residential schools showed PAL students outperformed peers by 2.5 times. Building on these results, the State plans to expand PAL to additional schools. On another note, teachers from KGBV schools receive training to improve classroom instruction.

RA 3- Strengthened Institutional Capacity and Community Participation

Community Engagement through Social Audit (DLI 3). All targets have been achieved except for Year 5, for which the 4th round of social audit is expected to be carried out with results on school performance available before June 2026. The mission also discussed the findings from the third round of social audit, which appear to show a decline compared to the second round. A possible explanation provided was that, unlike the previous rounds which involved internal assessors, the third round was conducted by Cluster Resource Persons, who are external to the schools, thereby eliminating potential bias in observations. Moreover, the mission endorsed the plan to carry out a third-party evaluation of the social audit, on a small and representative sample of schools to generate further insights.

School Leadership Training (DLI 8). Targets related to school leadership training are yet to be achieved. For Year 3 and 5. At the time of the mission, Phase 1 (covering 25% of school heads) was completed in February 2025, covering 12 leadership and 5 non-leadership competencies. Phase 2 (covering 34% of school heads) has completed the online component, with offline training to resume in October 2025. Phase 3 (covering 41% of school heads) is scheduled for completion by June 2026. Peer Learning Circles and Live Action Projects (LAP), to start offline in October 2025, aim to evaluate training effectiveness. Efforts are required to ensure the Program reaches its milestones before the end of the Program.

Capacity Building and Annual Work Plans and Budgets. SIEMAT's capacity building focuses on strengthening research and innovation and identifying key education KPIs for all implanting stakeholders across the Samagra Shiksha ecosystem. Development of the Arth software for Annual Work Plan and Budgeting continues, with rollout set for November 2025. The Mission was informed that budget utilization data for the financial year 2024–25 will be shared with the World Bank by November 2025.

Education Management Information System (EMIS). Progress has been made to consolidate 11 EMIS applications into the integrated LEAP App to support core departmental functions such as classroom observation, teacher and school leader training, and learning assessments. By September 2025, four applications had been integrated, tested, and deployed. Heavier applications like the LMS are linked externally to DIKSHA to leverage the national platform. The remaining applications are expected to be completed by November 2025, and timely completion will be critical to achieving the intended efficiency and monitoring gains.

Environment and Social Safeguards

The implementation of measures to strengthen capacity, improve school safety, and prevent and respond to school-related gender-based violence (SRGBV) has progressed steadily. Awareness videos have been

completed and disseminated. The mission suggested that a compendium of good practices is planned. SRGBV action plans, e-trainings for teachers and education officials, and functional SRGBV Committees are in place. The mission recommended that the GRM standard SOPs are finalized to allow anonymous reporting, distinguish GBV/SEA/SH cases from labor-related issues, and ensure sensitive handling of such cases. It was also recommended to ensure the composition of SRGBV Committees is revised to align with the ICC requirements under the POSH Act, and SRGBV action plans updated to include mapping of GBV/SEA/SH service providers and referral pathways.

Financial Management-related Aspects

FM performance has progressed smoothly. The Finance Controller position has been filled; however, about 30% of FM positions at state, district, and sub-district levels remain vacant and must be addressed urgently to ensure effective financial management. The internal audit for FY 2024–25 has been completed, and the State must submit the audit report, compliance, and responses to earlier audit observations. The statutory audit report for FY 2024–25 is under preparation and due by December 31, 2025. Responses to the Bank’s audit review letters for FY 2022–23 and 2023–24 are awaited and should be submitted by October 31, 2025. Fund flow performance has improved, with transfers from the Government of India to Samagra Shiksha now averaging 33 days.

Procurement Aspects

Procurement implementation is progressing well under both IPF and PforR components. Of the 12 IPF contracts, all have been signed except the PAL software package (US\$2 million), which will be re-tendered by September 2025, with award expected by January 2026. The EMIS contract will be foreclosed by mutual consent. Under the PforR component, 67 contracts valued at over US\$8 million have been signed, all time-bound actions in the Procurement Action Plan have been completed, and no complaints have been reported.

III. AGREED ACTIONS AND NEXT STEPS

The actions contained in the table below have been discussed and agreed.

Agreed Actions	Deadline
RA 1-Strengthen Foundational Learning	
Confirm that MGNREGA resources can be used to fund compound walls for remaining schools under DLI 4; and share a completion timeline with the World Bank	November 2025
Complete construction of compound walls in the remaining 3,000 schools/and ensure verification of achievement of results by the IVA	June 2026
Complete all pending FLN trainings (60-day, 120-day)/and ensure verification of achievement of results (60-day) by the IVA	January to August 2026
Develop communication materials to strengthen community engagement in all co-located Anganwadi centers	December 2025
Conduct social audits of MFS and all co-located Anganwadi centers, with a SWOT analysis to inform future Central Government policy	June 2026
Complete distribution of TLM and evaluate their use in schools and Anganwadi centers/and ensure verification of effective distribution by the IVA	December 2025

RA 2-Improved Quality of Teaching-Learning Interactions	
Rollout of need-based courses (Science, Social Science, Inclusive Education)	October to June 2026
Conduct Teacher Needs Analysis surveys independently and co-develop at least one teacher training course [SCERT]	June 2026
Resume classrooms observations, while ensuring intensity of observations, and increasing coverage of teachers	October to April 2026
Train school inspectors, MEOs, AMOs, and DIET faculty to integrate observations into their roles/ Develop KPIs for SCERT and DIETs linked to teacher professional development	April 2026
Complete the remaining 6 training sessions for SAC	December 2025
Provide data on the number of PAL sessions recorded taken by students	October to June 2026
RA 3 -Strengthened Institutional Capacity and Community Participation	
Carry out the 4 th round of the Social Audit to produce the school performance results/ and ensure verification of results by IVA	June 2026
Carry out a third-party evaluation of the social audit, on a small and representative sample of schools to generate further insights [suggestion from SPD Sir]	June 2026
Complete the school leadership training (both phases 2 and 3)/ and ensure verification of results by the IVA	October to April 2026
Share the budget utilization data for the financial year 2024–25 to update the Result Framework	December 2025
Ensure deployment, testing, and full functionality of all 7 remaining applications under the LEAP platform	January 2026
Environmental & Social Safeguards	
Update the five SRGBV plans to include the four newly agreed measures, accelerate their implementation, and report progress on pending activities.	October to November 2025
Allow impersonal/anonymous complaints on the GRM online portal by removing personal information as mandatory	October to November 2025
Disaggregate number of GRM cases to report on number of cases received on a) GBV/SEA/SH cases; b) Labor and working conditions	October to November 2025
Finalize SOPs to make the GRM sensitive to GBV/SEA/SH cases, including mapping of service providers and referral pathways	October to December 2025
Deliver training to State nodal institutions and technical consultants to enhance their understanding of the needs of SC/ST students	October to December 2025
Prepare an EHS compendium and document good practices, including environmental features in LEAP/FLN tools and tree plantation monitoring	November 2025
Conduct a technical E&S mission to visit schools and review implementation of E&S measures	December 2025
Financial Management	
Update the proposal to utilize the uncommitted IPF funds/Confirm if uncommitted funds under the IPF should be converted into PfOR spending [with potential DLRs with targets likely to be exceeded]	November 30, 2025
Respond to the Bank on Audit Review Letters	October 31 2025
Share the actions taken on the findings of the internal audit.	November 2025
Procurement	
Re-tender and Award PAL procurement package	December 2025
Upload in STEP all contract documents including all addendums, as well as payment information	October 2025